

Simulating Single-Gene Inheritance

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```
try:
    import au_molecular_genetics
    print("Already installed")
except ImportError:
    %pip install -q "au_molecular_genetics @ git+https://github.com/au-mbg/molecular_
genetics.git"
```

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import au_molecular_genetics.simulating_inheritance as amg_si
```

In this notebook we will study single-gene inheritance and probe the statistics behind it.

1 Monte Carlo Simulation with 1 child.

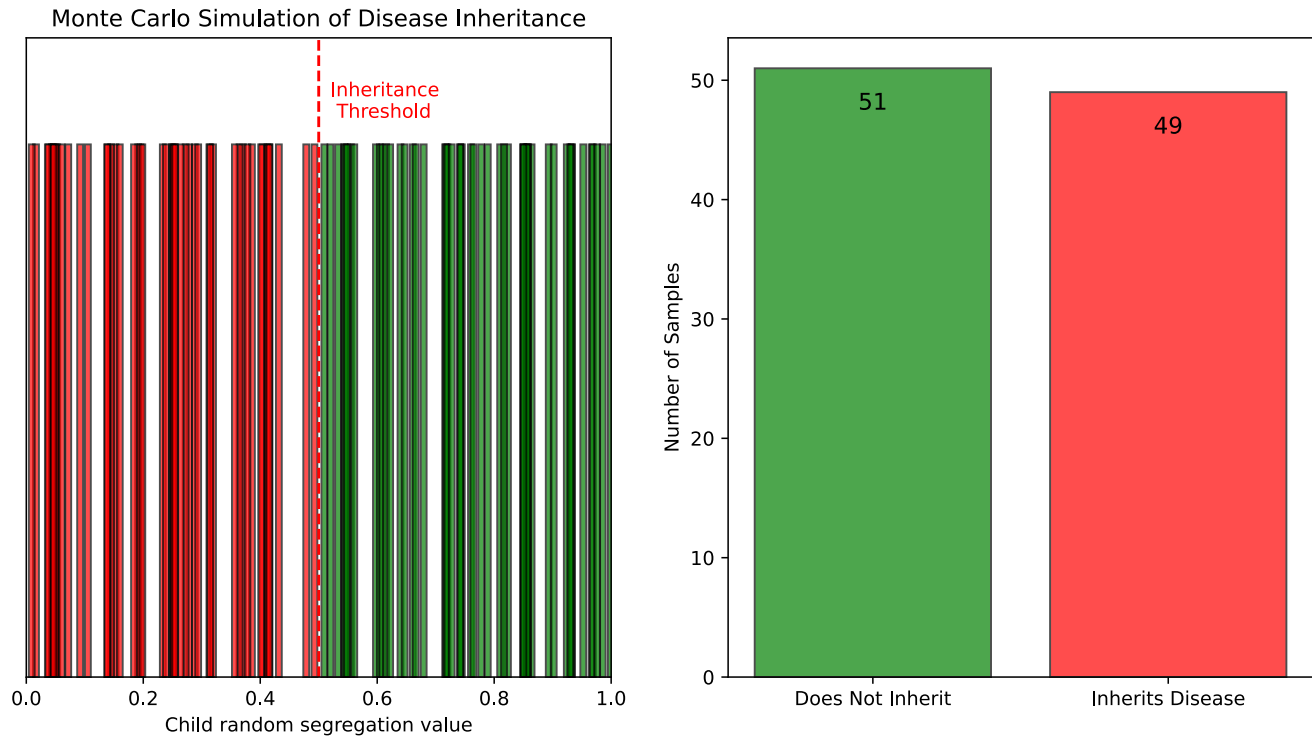
After having solved problem 62 in chapter 2, reconsider the situation of the couple III-4 and III-5. Each time they are expecting a child there are two possible outcomes

1. The child inherits the disease.
2. The child doesn't inherit the disease.

To illustrate this risk to the couple, we can simulate a large number of child births by drawing a uniformly random number between 0 and 1 and if the number is less than the probability of inheritance counting that as the child having inherited the disease.

The cell below makes this simulation by drawing `n_samples` random numbers and plotting each value on the left hand side and in the right-hand panel counts the number of children that did not and did inherit the disease. The probability of inheritance is controlled by the `inheritance_probability` input.

```
## Run this cell! ##
amg_si.simulate_one_child_inheritance_mc(n_samples=100, inheritance_probability=0.5)
```



Exercise 1:

With $n_{\text{samples}} = 100$ and $\text{inheritance_probability}=0.5$ what is the expected number of children that have inherited the disease?

Does the simulation repeatedly yield exactly that number? If not, why not?

Exercise 2:

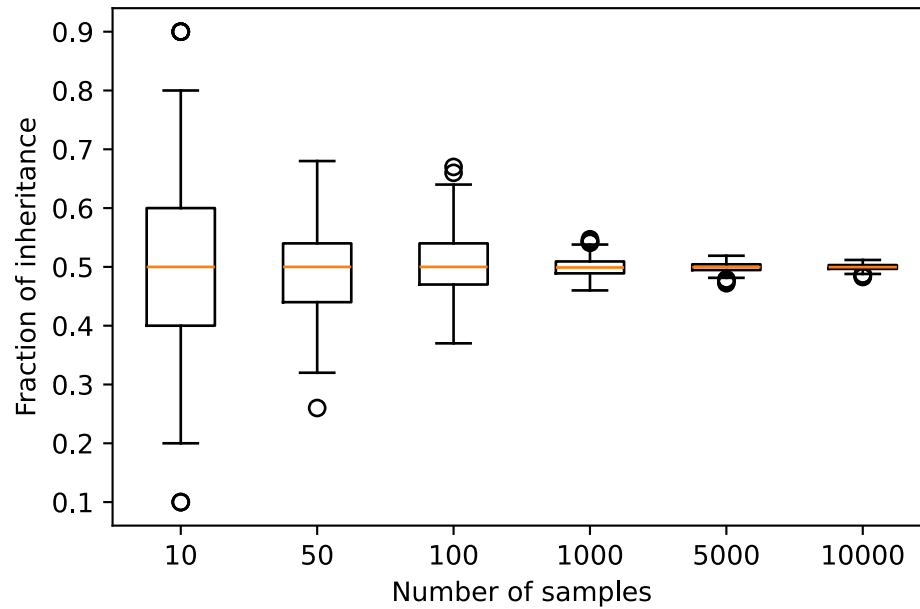
Set $\text{inheritance_probability}$ to 0.5 and 0.25 (the risk of a child inheriting an autosomal recessive disease if both parents are carriers). For each value, run the simulation with $n_{\text{samples}} = 1000$. How does the histogram change?

Exercise 3:

The cell below makes boxplots the fraction of children that inherit the disease as a function of the number of samples. Consider the following questions

- How does the spread of the fraction change as the number of samples increases?
- Why do the results vary much more for small numbers of samples than for large ones?
- What value do the results appear to approach as the number of samples becomes large?
- Why do simulations with $n_{\text{samples}} = 10$ sometimes give very high or very low fractions, even though the inheritance probability is 0.5?
- Is it “wrong” when a simulation with 10 samples gives a fraction of 0.8 or 0.2? Why or why not?

```
## Run this cell! ##
amg_si.one_child_convergence(inheritance_probability=0.5)
```



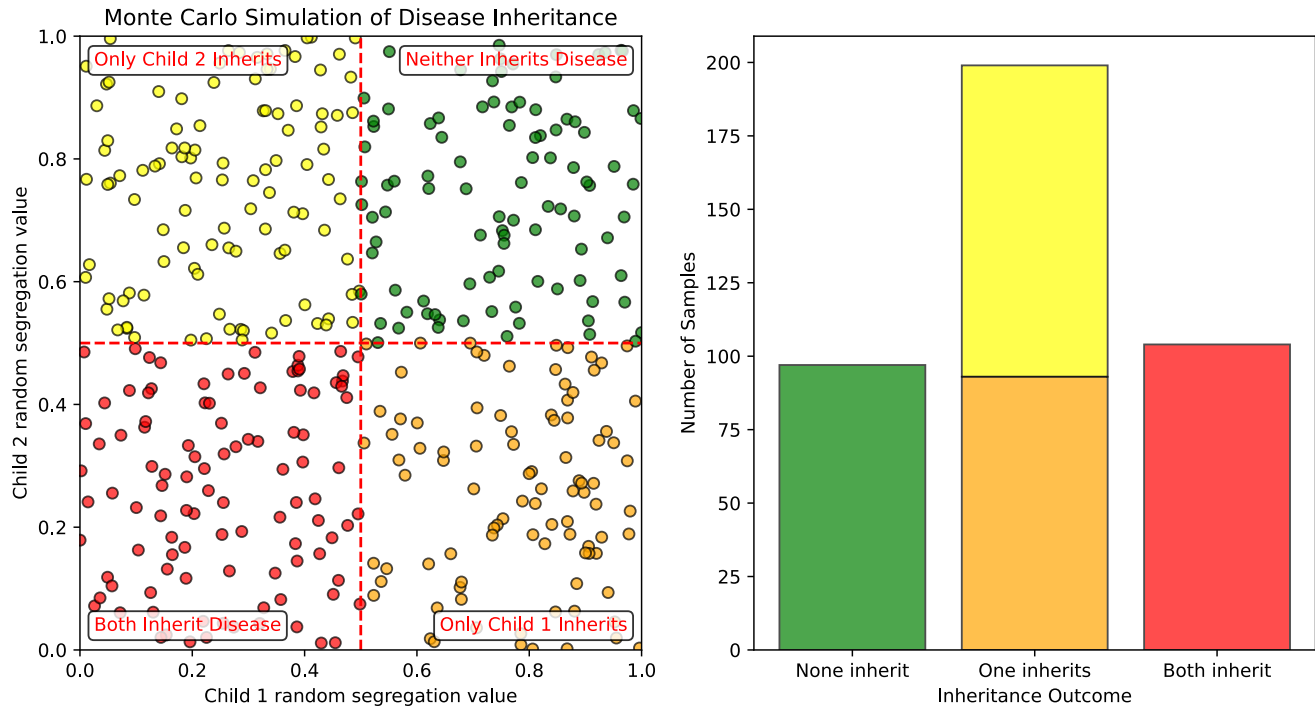
2 Monte Carlo Simulation with 2 children.

Now consider that the couple is planning to have two children. To illustrate the risk of both children inheriting the disease, we can extend the simulation with one child. The idea is the same, but now we have two dimensions - one for each child. A sample is simulated by drawing two random numbers c_1 and c_2 , now the possible outcomes are

1. None of the children inherit the disease ($c_1 > p$ and $c_2 > p$).
2. Child 1 inherits the disease ($c_1 < p$ and $c_2 > p$).
3. Child 2 inherits the disease ($c_1 > p$ and $c_2 < p$).
4. Both children inherit the disease ($c_1 < p$ and $c_2 < p$).

The cell below makes such a simulation, on the left the randomly drawn segregation values are shown and on the right a histogram of the number of samples with neither, one of, or both children inheriting the disease.

```
## Run this cell! ##
amg_si.simulate_two_children_inheritance_mc(n_samples=400, inheritance_probability=0.5)
```



Exercise 4:

With `inheritance_probability=0.5` the left-hand plot is split into 4 quadrants of equal area - why is that?

Why is the number of cases where one child inherits the disease higher than the the number of cases where none inherit the disease?

What is the area of the quadrant where both children inherit the disease? And how does this area relates to the risk of the couple having two children with the disease?

Exercise 5:

If you set `inheritance_probability=0.25`, what happens to the 4 quadrants? What happens to the histogram?

Exercise 6:

With `inheritance_probability=0.5` and `n_samples=400` what is the expected number of cases where both children have inherited the disease?

3 More children

This way of simulating could be extended to any number of children, however visualizing it becomes more challenging with three children since we would draw three numbers (c_1, c_2, c_3) in a 3D cube, which we could plot - but with four children we would draw four numbers (c_1, c_2, c_3, c_4) in a 4D “hypercube” which our senses are not particularly equipped to visualize.

Exercise 7:

With four children how many possible outcomes are there? It may help to think of it as how many unique sequences of length four with 0 (healthy child) and 1 (diseased child) are possible (E.g. 0000, 0001).

Binomial distribution

Another possibility is to draw directly from a binomial distribution, That means that if a disease has a probability p of being inherited, the probability of n children inheriting the disease is given by

$$P(k) = \binom{N}{k} p^k (1 - p)^{N-k},$$

Where N is the total number of children, k is the number of children who inherit the disease and p is the probability of inheritance.

The cell below draw samples from a binomial distribution and plots the results. You can change the parameters `n_children` (N), `n_samples` and `inheritance_probability` (p).

```
## Parameters ##
n_children = 4
n_samples = 1000
inheritance_probability = 0.5

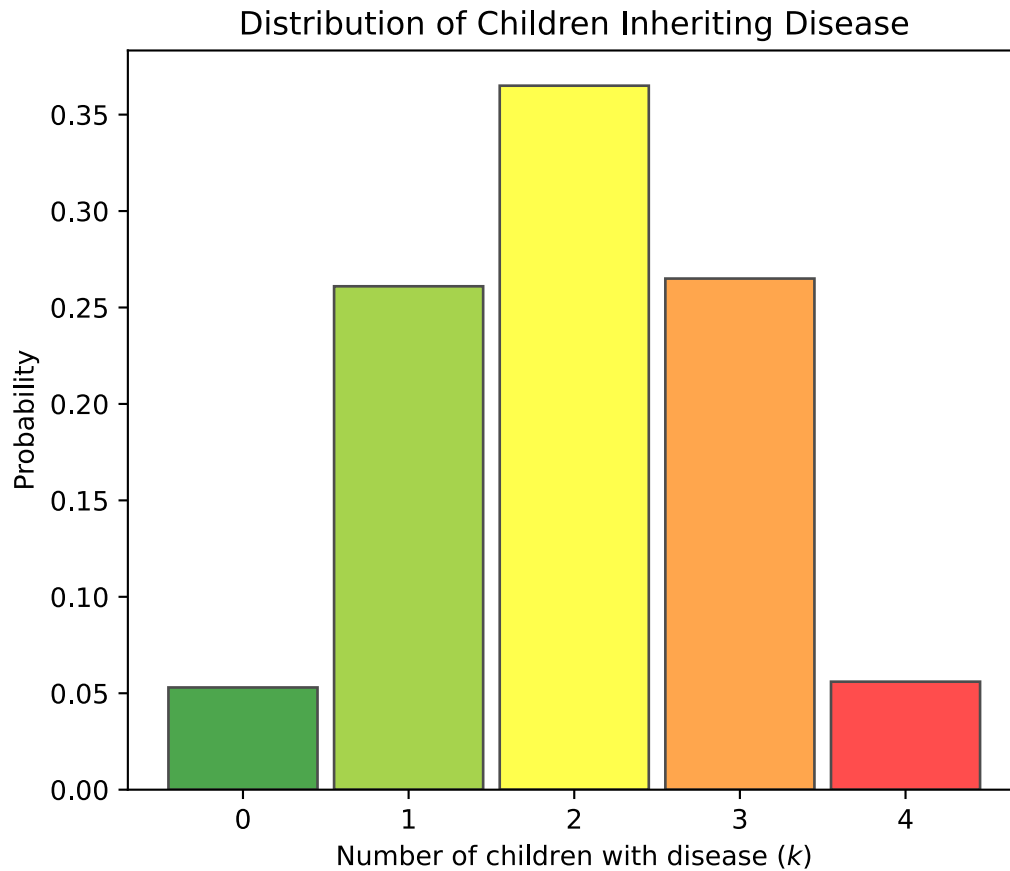
## Draw sample ##
sample = np.random.binomial(n=n_children, p=inheritance_probability, size=n_samples)

## Plotting the results ##
fig, ax = plt.subplots(figsize=(6, 5))

colors = amg_si.make_colors(n_children)

for n_child in range(0, n_children+1):
    ax.bar(n_child, (sample==n_child).sum()/n_samples, width=0.9, edgecolor='black',
           color=colors[n_child], alpha=0.7)

ax.set_xticks(range(n_children + 1))
ax.set_xlabel('Number of children with disease $(k)$')
ax.set_ylabel('Probability')
ax.set_title('Distribution of Children Inheriting Disease')
plt.show()
```



Exercise 8:

For $n_children = 4$ and $inheritance_probability = 0.5$ use the simulation to estimate the probability that no children inherit the disease and that all four children inherit the disease. Does this agree with your expectation? Are these two probabilities the same, why/why not?

Exercise 9:

Using the same geometric reasoning as in the one and two children cases, what is the “hypervolume” of the region where all four children are healthy? Hint: Consider your answer to problem 62C.